

spirit and body to act in this world. I am someone to make my life meaningful.

The second principle is spontaneity, acting on the moment with the judgement, knowledge and perception of the moment, not acting with the baggage of religion, tradition, history, teaching, cultural assumptions and prejudice.

The third principle is a new vision with values. It's to ask yourself what more can you do and how you bring your deepest values to work. The fourth principle is holism.

This comes essentially from quantum physics which teaches us that there is no such thing as separation in this world. Holism makes that impossible. We need to know what is outside the window because we influence what is outside the window and what is outside the window influences us.

The fifth principle is the importance of questions. Constant questions like why am I doing it this way, why do we make this product, why do we invest here, what is my life's purpose. Such questions make us creative leaders.

Then comes positive use of adversity. We should gain

"LEADERS MUST STAND UP AGAINST THE CROWD FOR WHAT THEY THINK IS RIGHT."

Danah Zohar

from our mistakes and learn how it can make us stronger.

The seventh principle is the celebration of diversity. Diversity is the stuff of life, the biological system strives on it and so do we. The eighth principle is to feel independent. Leaders must be willing to stand up against the crowd. Great leaders have seldom been fully appreciated in their time, but they stand for what they think is right.

The ninth principle is humility. You must be humble. Always question yourself. You must say I could be wrong. Ask yourself if you really have the right to stand up against the crowd. Compassion is the 10th principle. Compassion is not pity. It's to feel the joy, sadness and terror of others as though they are yours.

The last two principles are a call to vocation and the sense of vocation. It is the call to make one's leadership matter and accomplish something. A person with a sense of vocation feels this call. He feels responsible for the world. And then he has the right to become a leader.

D I S C U S S I O N

Q. You told us not to use our mind, not to trust our five senses. But you say this using your five senses and we listen to that using our five senses. If I don't listen to my mind, what do I listen to?

Vasudev: I'm not saying don't use the mind. I don't know who said that. But if you do not recognise the limitations of the mind and senses, it is a great folly, because it limits the very possibility of life, the experiential possibility of life. Your senses feed the mind, it is through the agencies of your senses that the mind gets all its information and it is not reliable.

When the limitations of being within the limits of your body and mind bother you and you want to transcend that, only then spiritual process enters your life. It is extremely important that we understand that there are other ways to perceive life. The animals, the birds and insects are capable of perceiving things that we cannot perceive. Through your senses all you can perceive is only the physicality. Everything that happens in your

existence doesn't happen outside, it happens inside. But your senses are incapable of turning inwards. Your senses are essentially outward bound. I am not saying that they are useless, they are the instruments of survival but once you come as a human being survival is not enough. He wants to be something more than what he is right now. How would you do that? How would you do that with your intellect because your intellect is functioning on limited information that you have gathered through your senses? I'm not denying your sense or intellect. It is only because we have these senses that we can even look at this. That is where we start. But we don't have to end there.

Q. We often tell our children to dream big, think big so that they can eventually be somewhere. Now, dreaming is in the mind and if we don't dream, the mind doesn't work. If the mind stops working, where are we heading actually?

Vasudev: That was the idea. This is not about drawing conclusion

because conclusion is death, confusion is a possibility. Isn't it true that your psychological process is happening with limited information that you have in your mind? So don't you think it is important at least to explore other ways to perceive life?

Q. Is it not through the mind that we gain our experiences or even move inward? How do we go inwards?

Vasudev: There is a certain intelligence of creation within you which you are not exploring at all. You are depending too much upon your intellectual capabilities. What you call life, what you call creation, what you call source of creation is intelligence. But you have no access to that, though it is happening within you. This is a tragedy. I am just trying to avoid the tragedy.

Q. Is there a spirit or not? What should we follow—the spirit or physical?

Zohar: Spiritual and physical are not separate. One enacts through the other. We could not be spirits in this world if we did not

have the bodies to act in this world. And we could not have bodies to act in this world if we were not enlightened by spirits.

Akhtar: Being a writer there is something which I have experienced again and again. When I am writing there comes a moment when I feel surprised that how I learnt this word or this term, from where is it coming. Sometimes I have experienced, very rarely, that someone else is writing and I am watching. I am just reading it as what is happening. But the fact is that ultimately I write in the language that I have heard and learnt. No inspiration has made me write a line in Chinese. So ultimately whatever has come out in the most inspiring moment was my intake, thanks to my five senses.

Q. Since we cannot look within just with our senses, how do we look within?

Vasudev: Is that true that you cannot use your senses to look inwards? Please try and see.

Full speeches and debate at:

<http://www.indiatodayconclave.com>

